

Page 06 — Not found /404.html

Audited: 7 September 2026 · main 32fcad7
Method: headless Chromium at 1440 / 820 / 390 with real webfonts and a live feed injected · geometry and contrast extraction
Status: Audit only — no code changes applied.

3	0	1	2
CHANGES PROPOSED	HIGH	MEDIUM	LOW

74 **UX score, out of 100 — the highest of any page with content on it.** A 404 that fits in one screen, keeps the reader inside the site, and now offers three real essays instead of a shrug. The remaining points are contrast and one layout detail.

 Blake Cody

[Home](#) [Articles](#) [Book](#) [Reflect](#) [About](#) [Substack ↗](#)

ERROR 404

This page wandered off.

The link might be broken, or the page may have moved. Let's get you back on track.

[← Back home](#) [Read the articles →](#)

OR START WITH SOMETHING RECENT



JANUARY 10, 2026

The Discipline You Keep When Nobody Is Watching

I used to think discipline was a thing you summoned on the hard days. It is not — it...

[Read on Substack →](#)



FEBRUARY 11, 2026

What I Got Wrong About Leading With Love

I used to think discipline was a thing you summoned on the hard days. It is not — it...

[Read on Substack →](#)



MARCH 12, 2026

A Week of Writing Everything Down

I used to think discipline was a thing you summoned on the hard days. It is not — it...

[Read on Substack →](#)

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[Read on Substack ↗](#)

1440×900, and the whole page fits: measured document height 932px against a 900px viewport — 1.04 viewports. The three recent essays are new since the last pass.

blakecody.com — UI change log — 06-404

The recent-posts row landed, and it changed the page

The SEO report's **C38** proposed adding the three most recent essays here, reusing `postCard()` and `data-limit="3"` so it would populate itself. That is exactly what shipped.

It matters more than its size suggests. A 404 is a person who wanted something specific and did not get it — the most likely moment on the whole site for someone to give up. This page now converts that moment into a reading choice rather than a dead end, and it does it in one screen.

A. Findings

U25 Three contrast failures, on a page with very little text **MEDIUM** → V2

Element	Text	Size	Ratio
<code>.eyebrow</code>	"ERROR 404"	13.1px	3.38
<code>.section-label</code>	"OR START WITH SOMETHING RECENT"	13.1px	3.38
<code>.post-meta</code>	each essay date	12.2px	3.38

This page has 49 words of its own plus three cards, and three of its text styles fail AA. Proportionally it is the worst-affected page on the site — and the "ERROR 404" eyebrow is the first thing a confused visitor looks for to confirm what happened.

Same single cause as everywhere else: `--accent-soft #c46a4f` used for small text. One token change closes this page along with `articles`, `book`, `reflect` and `about`.

U26 The card CTAs are misaligned here too **LOW** → H5

```
.post-more bottoms: 771, 771, 747    24px ragged
```

The same top-aligned card contents as the homepage and the archive, so the same 24px step whenever one title wraps to fewer lines. More visible here than elsewhere because there are only three cards and they sit near the bottom edge of a single-screen page, where the ragged line is the last thing the eye crosses.

Fixed by the same two lines of flexbox as **H5** — and fixing it once in `.post-body` fixes all three pages that render cards.

U27 The two exits compete rather than rank LOW

MEASURED

```
.substack-btn  "← Back home"      145×49    solid accent fill  
.see-all      "Read the articles →"  text link, inline, margin-left:18px
```

A solid button and a text link, side by side, offering two reasonable next steps. But now that three actual essays sit directly beneath them, "Read the articles →" is the weakest of three overlapping options — go home, go to the archive, or read one of these specific pieces.

The strongest option is the one you just added and it is the one with no call to action attached.

FIX

Drop "Read the articles →" from the button row. Let "← Back home" be the single primary action, and let the essay cards below be the alternative — they are more concrete than a link to a list. If you want the archive reachable, put "See all essays →" after the three cards, where it belongs as a continuation rather than a competitor.

Also worth removing the inline `style="margin-left:18px"` on that link while you are there — the only inline style in the page's markup.

U28 What is right — most of it KEEP

- **It fits in one screen.** 932px against a 900px viewport. The whole message, the way back, and three essays, with no scrolling. Nothing else on the site achieves this.
- **The H1 is human** — "This page wandered off." at 54.4px, 13.62 contrast. Not "404", not "Error", not an apology.
- **The site does not fall away.** Full nav, full footer, same palette and type. A reader who mistypes a URL is not ejected into a system page.
- **A real button** at 145×49, above the 44px floor.
- **Mobile is 2.32 folds** — still short even with the cards stacked.
- **Heading tree** H1 → H2 → H3 ×3, clean.

Evidence log

Check	Result
Page depth	1440 → 932px (1.04 folds) · 820 → 1,180px (1.00) · 390 → 1,959px (2.32)
Headings	H1 54.4px → H2 → H3 ×3 — clean
Contrast	3 failures , all <code>--accent-soft</code> at 3.38 · H1 13.62 ✓ · sub 5.52 ✓ · excerpts 5.52 ✓
Buttons	<code>.substack-btn</code> 145×49 ✓
Cards	3 × 207×360 · CTA bottoms 771 / 771 / 747
Mobile nav	clientW 170 · scrollW 385 · 3 items off-screen (R1)

Content column / focus

`.wrap` 720px (**V1**) · browser-default focus ring (**R3**)

UI page 06 of 7 complete.

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